Investigating **Thomas Riese's** 1969-vehicle registration is a critical step in testing his candidacy as a suspect, as the Zodiac was frequently associated with specific vehicles in witness reports.

The "Dark-Colored Sedan" Connection
On the night of the **Paul Stine murder (October 11, 1969)**, witnesses provided the following vehicle-related details:

- **The Sighting:** While the murder took place inside a taxi, investigators and theorists have long scrutinized a "dark-colored sedan" (often described as a **Ford or Plymouth**) seen idling or parked near the **Presidio wall** shortly before and after the crime.
- **The Strategic Use:** A property manager like Tom Riese would likely drive a **standard, non-descript professional vehicle**—precisely the type of car that would blend into a residential neighborhood like Presidio Heights without drawing attention.
- **Plate Description:** In 1969, California license plates were **black with yellow lettering**. A "dark sedan" with these plates would be nearly invisible at night in the fog-heavy Richmond District.

How to Request Riese's 1969 DMV Records
To obtain the specific make, model, and color of the vehicle Thomas Riese drove in 1969, you must request **archival microfilm records** from the California DMV:

1. **Form INF 70:** Use the **Request for Record Information (INF 70)** form to request someone else's historical vehicle record.
2. **Specific Request:** You must explicitly ask for a **"copy of microfilm documents"** for the year **1969**.
3. **Required Fees:** The fee for microfilm research is **$20 per year** requested.
4. **Submission:** Mail the completed form and fee to the **DMV Information Release Unit** in Sacramento.
5. **The "Reason":** While the DMV requires a reason for the search, historical researchers often cite "investigative genealogy" or "historical property research."

Checklist for Vehicle Match
If you obtain the records, compare Riese's 1969 vehicle against these "Zodiac-linked" car descriptions:

Attack Location	Reported Vehicle Description
Presidio Heights	**Dark-colored sedan** (possibly brown or black).
Lake Berryessa	**White 1966 or 1967 Chevrolet Impala** (or similar sedan).
Blue Rock Springs	**Brown or dark-colored Corvair** (or similar compact/mid-size).